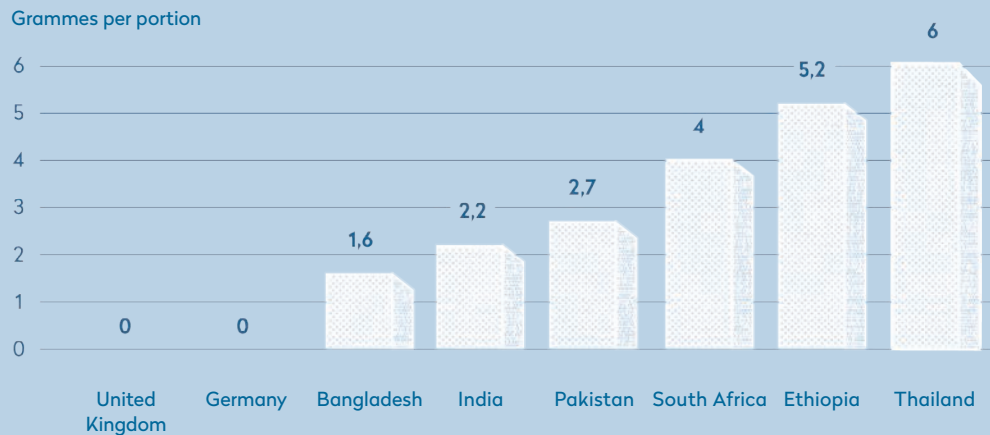


SAME PRODUCT, DIFFERENT MARKETS: OBVIOUS DOUBLE STANDARD

Wheat-based infant cereals with milk are Nestlé's founding product. Today, Cerelac is sold all over the world, although its composition varies considerably from country to country.

Added sugar content of the same Cerelac wheat product in different countries



Source: Public Eye and IBFAN (2024). Analysis of the nutritional information appearing on the products, or, when the added sugar content is not declared, results of laboratory analyses.

using idealizing imagery, it's not transparent when it comes to added sugar. To uncover these "hidden sugars," we obtained Cerelac and Nido products from a number of countries to examine their labels and, in some cases, have them analyzed by a specialized laboratory.

This turned out to be more complicated than expected. Several laboratories approached in Switzerland refused to conduct the sugar analysis of Nestlé products. One lab even wrote that it could not take part in the project because the results "could potentially have a negative impact" on its existing customers. Stonewalled, we decided to approach a lab based in Belgium. The results are edifying.

One sugar cube per portion

Cerelac is the world's number one baby cereal brand, with sales exceeding \$1 billion in 2022, according to Euro-monitor. We examined 114 products sold in Nestlé's main markets in Africa, Asia and Latin America. No less than 106 of them (93 percent) contained added sugar.

For 66 of these products, we were able to determine the amount of added sugar. On average, our analysis

found almost 4 grams per serving, or about one sugar cube. The highest amount – 7.3 grams per serving – was detected in a product sold in the Philippines and targeted at six-month-old babies.

While Nestlé prominently highlights the vitamins, minerals and other nutrients contained in its products it's not transparent when it comes to added sugar.

In India, where sales surpassed \$250 million in 2022, all Cerelac baby cereals contain added sugar, on average nearly 3 grams per serving. The same situation prevails in South Africa, the main market on the African continent, where all Cerelac baby cereals contain four grams or more of added sugar per serving. In Brazil, the world's second-largest market, with sales of around \$150 million in 2022, three-quarters of Cerelac baby cereals (known as